stronger one's commitment to the ally, the higher the risk of entrapment. The risks of abandonment and entrapment tend to vary inversely, and reducing one tends to increase the other.[12] India's growing alignment with the United States has been criticised at home for contributing to reducing India's strategic autonomy.[13] Part of the "entrapment risk" for India, if it enters into an alliance with the United States, is the effect such an alliance will have on India's relationships with Russia and Iran. Garver observes in this volume that India's need to counter Beijing's courtship of Tehran raises questions for India's relations with the United States and for India's practice of strategic autonomy. Retaining the close relationship with Russia is arguably more critical. As Raghavan points to in his chapter, an important outcome of India's long-term collaboration with Russia is that Soviet/Russian-origin weapons and equipment today form the backbone of India's military capability, and an abrupt shift from Russian to Western weapons systems would create defence vulnerabilities. Also, New Delhi sees its relationship with Moscow as important to preventing the creation of a hostile Russia–China axis.

As both Prasad and Raghavan debate, there is a concern in India about alliance abandonment, in particular due to the longer geographical distance from the United States to India than from the United States to Japan. Raghavan notes that if India enters into an alliance with the United States, this increases the likelihood of a stronger China–Russia axis, and India would then face a situation where it is dependent on strong commitment from a geographically distant ally representing an effective bulwark for India against two large geographically proximate adversaries. Garver states that the weakness of US support during the crisis at Doklam on the Sino–Indian border in 2017 came as a surprise to many in New Delhi. In his chapter, Garver argues that American lassitude in the midst of what India perceives to be the most